

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, colder, intermittent snow, high 38. **Tonight**, windy, snow, slow and slippery roads, low 31. **Tomorrow**, snow early, windy, cloudy, high 38. Weather map is on Page 20.

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Prices in Canada may be higher

\$6.00

That’s No Sand Trap. It’s East Wing Rubble Dumped On a Public Golf Course.



KENT NISHIMURA FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Golfing the municipal links at East Potomac Park with a mound of dirt and debris from the East Wing of the White House.

Trump Plans to Turn a People’s Park Into a Luxury Destination

By SHAWN MCCREESH

WASHINGTON — This is a story about mud and power in Washington.

It begins at the turn of the 20th century, when this was a smaller, swampier place. Back then, there were great mud flats clogging up the Potomac River, just south of where the Washington Monument stood. Ships could not pass over the shallows. Sewage collected there. A plan was made to build them up into something pretty. The U.S. Army Corps of Engineers got to work, dredging the river, piling mud atop the marsh.

The crescent-shaped island that appeared became an important piece of Washington’s modern geography. The Jefferson Memorial was built on the island’s western lip, which backs up to the Tidal Basin and the National Mall. The rest of the man-made island was turned into a public park called East Potomac.

It’s a neat place. There are hundreds of cherry blossom trees, a road for cycling that wraps around the perimeter of the island, and a primo picnic area at its eastern tip. Most of the park is taken up by an affordable golf course that has been there in some form since the beginning. The course, East Potomac Golf Links, is a bit shabby,

but the prices are unbeatable: \$42 for 18 holes.

Not much had changed about East Potomac over the decades until one day last October when some dump trucks showed up. The trucks were sent by the White House. They were carrying mud.

The trucks drove onto the golf course and, somewhere between the fourth and ninth holes, began dumping mounds and mounds of the stuff. Tiny bits of rebar, wiring and specks of white plaster poked out from the piles. Word quickly spread among the golfers about the mystery mud. Turned out it was the remains of the East

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Trump Defiance on Tariffs Poses Headache for G.O.P.

Clinging to Unpopular Levies Despite Ruling Could Hurt His Party in Midterms

By SHANE GOLDMACHER and KATIE GLUECK

President Trump’s defiant response to the Supreme Court decision striking a blow against his signature economic tool pushed the Republican Party further down an uncomfortable path of defending tariffs that are unpopular with the public.

Lashing out at the majority of justices who ruled against him as “fools and lap dogs,” Mr. Trump dismissed the most sweeping judicial rebuke of his second term on Friday as little more than a technicality as he vowed to plow ahead with new, across-the-globe tariffs using a different law.

“We have very powerful alternatives,” Mr. Trump declared, announcing a new 10 percent import tax. “For those who thought they had us.”

On Saturday, Mr. Trump said he was raising his new global tariff to 15 percent. [Page 12.]

Yet the painful political reality for Republicans, even those allied with the president, is that his tariff regime has proved deeply unpopular. Some privately lamented that Mr. Trump had missed a chance to walk them back ahead of a midterm election expected to turn heavily on the economy, instead recommitting to a policy that divides his party.

“It was bad policy,” Representative Don Bacon, a retiring Republican from Nebraska who has clashed with Mr. Trump on the issue of tariffs and other matters, said in an interview. “It’s also bad politics.”

A majority of Americans and 58 percent of independent voters opposed Mr. Trump’s tariffs, according to a New York Times/Siena University poll released last month. At a moment when the top issue for voters is the cost of living, Republicans are waging an uphill battle defending tariffs on imports that economists have repeatedly said ultimately result in

higher prices for consumers. A Fox News poll last month showed that tariffs ranked among Mr. Trump’s worst-performing issues.

Mr. Trump loves tariffs anyway. He insists the economists are wrong. Import taxes are so close to his heart that he has frequently called “tariff” his favorite word in the dictionary, and he has been talking up the importance of trade deficits for decades. As president, he has deployed tariffs as a foundation of both his economic and foreign policy agendas.

“This was an important case to me,” Mr. Trump said Friday.

Some Republicans had been hopeful in the immediate aftermath of the ruling that it might take some of the political pressure off them and ease rising prices.

Mr. Trump dashed those hopes almost immediately.

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ANNA ROSE LAYDEN FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

President Trump scolded the justices who ruled against him.

UNCERTAINTY The ruling could distract Europe from other challenges. News Analysis. PAGE 12

REFUNDS When will tariff money be returned? Maybe never, the Treasury secretary said. PAGE 11

Deadlier Risks If U.S. Attacks Iran 2nd Time

By MARK MAZZETTI
and HELENE COOPER

WASHINGTON — President Trump is considering committing the United States to another military campaign against Iran, a decision that carries the risk of igniting a conflict that could prove to be longer, deadlier and far more dangerous than last year’s 12-day war.

Last June, the United States joined a campaign against Iran that Israel had begun, and Mr. Trump gave the military a specific goal: to bomb Iranian nuclear facilities and set back Tehran’s ability to one day make a nuclear weapon. Within days of the U.S. strikes, all sides agreed to a cease-fire. There were no American casualties.

Now, the Pentagon is in the midst of the largest military buildup in the Middle East in two decades, and Mr. Trump is considering a far more expansive operation — this time led by U.S. forces — without saying publicly what he hopes to achieve. Would a campaign once again be focused on Iran’s nuclear sites? Would there be additional strikes to eviscerate Iran’s ballistic missile arsenal, which Iran has insisted it would not give up through negotiation?

Or, could Mr. Trump’s goal be something he has often said was dangerous folly: using the mili-

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GABRIELA BHASKAR/THE NEW YORK TIMES

Rejuvenation in the Alps

Bagni Vecchi, a spa and hotel in Bormio, Italy. Hot springs attracted Olympics fans. Sports, Page 5.

A Somber Perspective From the Skiers Who Got Out as a Doomed Group Arrived

By KURT STREETER

Last Sunday morning, two parties moved through the mountains above Donner Summit in opposite directions — one heading out from a cluster of backcountry cabins called the Frog Lake Huts, the other hiking in. The groups never saw each other. Only one would return whole.

The party heading out consisted of four friends who had just spent three days at the huts, perched high on the crest of the Sierra Nevada. Among them was Kurt Gensheimer, a trail builder and backcountry veteran from Verdi, Nev.

“It was the most amazing conditions I can remember,” Mr. Gensheimer said. Bluebird skies, no

Sensing Urgency Before Deadly Avalanche

wind, the mountains to themselves. The biggest storm of the season was bearing down, and the four friends wanted to be gone before it hit.

The party heading in was much larger — clients and guides from Blackbird Mountain Guides, which Mr. Gensheimer described as a highly respected outfit. The same storm that ushered his party out did not, apparently, keep the Blackbird group home.

Two days later, on Tuesday, Feb. 17, the storm claimed at least eight lives. The Blackbird party was on

a north-facing slope near Perry’s Point when an enormous slab of snow broke loose, sweeping all 15 members of the group downhill. Six survived and nine were killed — the deadliest avalanche in the United States in more than four decades. The nine bodies were recovered on Friday and Saturday after conditions finally eased.

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NATIONAL 13-22

The Surge of ‘Slopulism’

The online claims of self-appointed sleuths, which are often light on evidence and heavy on partisan rage, are seeping into policy. PAGE 13

Secret Passage to Freedom

A crawlspace hidden in what is now an East Village museum was a link to the Underground Railroad. PAGE 15

OBITUARIES 23-25

A Television Heartthrob

Eric Dane, a star of “Grey’s Anatomy,” died 10 months after announcing his A.L.S. diagnosis. He was 53. PAGE 23



INTERNATIONAL 4-12

To Build a Better Future

Gisèle Pelicot stayed silent after dozens of men were convicted of raping her. Now she is speaking out. PAGE 4

METROPOLITAN

A Sterling Career Is at Risk

After 45 years of coaching basketball in Queens, Ron Naclerio had a Hall of Fame résumé. His victory lap, however, became complicated. PAGE 1

SUNDAY STYLES

(Only) Appearances Count

The influencer Braden Peters has emerged as a beacon for a group of narcissistic young men. PAGE 10

Complicated Politics of Style

The new first lady of New York City, Rama Duwaji, takes her place amid a spotlight of fashion shows. PAGE 1



ARTS & LEISURE

A New Role for Radcliffe

The “Harry Potter” actor is starring in a play that has a message “that might be vital for somebody to hear.” PAGE 14

So Much to See This Spring

New York stages will soon be filled with theater, concerts, dance and more. We’ve listed the hottest tickets. PAGE 17

SUNDAY BUSINESS

Challenge to the Free Market

President Trump’s economic policy has drifted far from the principles that long defined the Republican Party. PAGE 6

Eager, and Anxious, Over A.I.

Tech leaders worry about the public’s underwhelming enthusiasm for their plans to remake the world. PAGE 1

SUNDAY OPINION

M. Gessen

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